

Component 3: Modern Drama and Literary Heritage Texts (coursework)

The focus of this component is:

Assignment A – Modern drama

Assignment B – Literary heritage texts.

Content

Students will study **two** set texts for this component: one of the modern drama set texts and one of the literary heritage set texts. The full list of set texts for this component is as follows.

A choice of one text from Modern Drama.

<i>A View from the Bridge</i>	Arthur Miller
<i>An Inspector Calls</i>	J B Priestley
<i>The Curious Incident of the Dog in the Night-time</i>	Simon Stephens
<i>Kindertransport</i>	Diane Samuels
<i>Death and the King's Horseman</i>	Wole Soyinka

A choice of one text from Literary Heritage.

<i>Romeo and Juliet</i>	William Shakespeare
<i>Macbeth</i>	William Shakespeare
<i>The Merchant of Venice</i>	William Shakespeare
<i>Pride and Prejudice</i>	Jane Austen
<i>Great Expectations</i>	Charles Dickens
<i>The Scarlet Letter</i>	Nathaniel Hawthorne

Teaching should focus on the study of **whole texts**, developing students' comprehension and critical reading skills, as well as their ability to produce clear and coherent writing using accurate Standard English. Wider reading of literary texts is also encouraged to help students develop their skills.

Understanding the relationship between a text and its context (AO4)

There are different kinds, or categories, of context which affect writers' work and the reader's response to it. Teaching should include:

- the writer's own life and individual situation, including the place and time of writing, only where these relate to the text
- the historical setting, time and location of the text
- social and cultural contexts (for example, attitudes in society; expectations of different cultural groups)

Assessment overview

Component 3 is available as an alternative to Component 2.

Component 3 Coursework assesses 40% of the total English Literature qualification.

The assessment of the component is through two coursework assignments, internally set and assessed, and externally moderated by Pearson.

Assignment setting

Students must complete **two** coursework assignments.

Students must respond to two coursework assignments, which may be self-generated or devised by their teacher. Students can be involved in choosing which texts to write about and the devising of the task. There is no requirement for students in a cohort to write on different texts. Students may all write on the same text.

Assignment A

The assignment should be based on one of the modern drama texts listed below.

The assignment will be marked out of 30 with 15 marks for AO1 and 15 marks for AO2.

A choice of one text from Modern Drama

<i>A View from the Bridge</i>	Arthur Miller
<i>An Inspector Calls</i>	J B Priestley
<i>The Curious Incident of the Dog in the Night-time</i>	Mark Haddon (adapted by Simon Stephens)
<i>Kindertransport</i>	Diane Samuels
<i>Death and the King's Horseman</i>	Wole Soyinka

Setting the question

The assignment must allow students to access AO1 and AO2.

Assignments could take the following formats:

- Explore the ways in which Priestley presents women in *An Inspector Calls*.
- In what ways does Miller present conflict in *A View from the Bridge*?

Assignment B

The assignment should be based on one of the literary heritage texts listed below.

The assignment will be marked out of 30 with 10 marks for AO1, 10 marks for AO2 and 10 marks for AO4.

A choice of one text from Literary Heritage

<i>Romeo and Juliet</i>	William Shakespeare
<i>Macbeth</i>	William Shakespeare
<i>The Merchant of Venice</i>	William Shakespeare
<i>Pride and Prejudice</i>	Jane Austen
<i>Great Expectations</i>	Charles Dickens
<i>The Scarlet Letter</i>	Nathaniel Hawthorne

Setting the question

Assignment B must allow students to access AO1, AO2 and AO4.

Assignments could take one of the following formats:

- Jane Austen allows the reader to see many different forms of love in *Pride and Prejudice*. To what extent do you agree? You must consider language, form and structure and refer to the context of the novel.
- How does Dickens portray city life in *Great Expectations*? You must consider language, form and structure and refer to the context of the novel.

Teaching should focus on the study of **whole texts**, developing students' comprehension and critical reading, as well as their ability to produce clear and coherent writing using accurate Standard English. To help students develop their skills, wider reading of literary texts is also encouraged.

Assignment taking

Authenticity

Students must sign the Coursework Authentication Sheet in *Appendix 2* to confirm that they have produced their coursework independently.

Teachers must also sign the Coursework Authentication Sheet to confirm that students have been sufficiently supervised to ensure the authenticity of the work.

Collaboration

Students must work independently in producing their coursework.

Teacher feedback

- Teachers may advise students in the production of coursework. Teachers may suggest general improvements to the coursework at a draft stage, but it is the student's responsibility to make any corrections and update the work.
- Student work must not be rewritten after it has been marked.
- Students should be informed at the start of the teaching that they must not plagiarise other work. Students must acknowledge sources in their work and be advised how to do so. Teachers should be alert to essays derived from other sources – such as the internet – when signing the declaration on the coursework front sheet.

Presentation of the work

- Each piece of coursework should contain the student's name, the date on which the work was completed, the mark awarded and a brief teacher comment justifying the mark. This comment should be based on the assessment criteria for the mark range awarded.
- Coursework pieces may be handwritten or word processed.

Word count

There is no prescribed word length for the coursework paper. Typically, each assignment may be between 650–800 words, but there are no penalties for exceeding this guidance.

Assignment marking

Assessment of coursework

Teachers must mark coursework according to the assessment criteria on pages 21–22. Teachers should use their professional judgement to apply the criteria appropriately and fairly to the work of students.

Students should be awarded the appropriate mark within any range on a 'best fit' basis, balancing strengths and weaknesses in each essay. Answers may display characteristics of more than one level, and where this happens, markers must use professional judgement to decide which level is most appropriate. For example, a passage in the assignment may contain characteristics of Level 4 while the rest of the assignment tends towards Level 3. The outcome may therefore be a high Level 3.

Standardisation of coursework

Where there is more than one teacher of the coursework option in a centre, the centre should conduct internal standardisation. This can be carried out by paired marking.

Completed coursework should be kept secure in the centre until at least six months after the examination session. Coursework may then be returned to students.

Final assessment of coursework at the end of the course

There will be two marks out of 30 which will be combined to make one mark out of 60. At the end of the course, the coursework may be re-assessed and the marks adjusted in light of internal standardisation.

Teachers should reward the quality of the writing and reading demonstrated in the coursework assignment. A second opinion, by a teacher other than the class teacher, will enable the centre to arrive at an objective judgement on achievement.

Coursework submission

Towards the end of the course centres will be required to send a sample of coursework to a Pearson-appointed coursework moderator. Final coursework marks for each student should be recorded on the coursework front sheet in *Appendix 2*. Teachers should photocopy the number of sheets required. The coursework frontsheet should be attached to the front of the coursework essay.

Please refer to the Joint Council for Qualifications (JCQ) document *Instructions for conducting non-examination assessments* for further information.